Standard Operating Procedure (SOP)

Country Specific Requirements Sweden

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Applicability

Bayer Level:	CH, PH

This document is electronically approved (signatures on the last page)

Distribution Sheet for Quality Regulations

Division/Business Unit ☒ PH ☒ CH

GBS Location
☐ Global Business Services Barcelona
☐ Global Business Services Costa Rica/Brazil
☐ Global Business Services Manila
☒ Global Business Services Gdansk
☐ Global Business Services Bangalore
☐ Global Business Services Dalian
☐ Global Business Services Germany

Region/ Country
☐ Global
☒ Specific Country: Sweden

Relevance for R&D QMS
☐ Affected
☐ Interface
☒ N/A

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Document Author(s):	Patryk Sikora (GPSJP)
Document Approver(s):	CQH: Helene Sinclair (GHINA) PTC Team Lead/SME: Katarzyna Mazur-Kominek (GLISG)
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Relevant Process and Activities:	PTC

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1 Scope and Framework

1.1 Scope

Bayer Country Quality Units are accountable for a GMP compliant Product Technical Complaint Management within their respective countries. Within this responsibility they are supported by the respective Global Business Service in process steps like complaint initiation, classification forwarding for investigation to the RQU, and final approval including complaint sample management and reimbursement process.

This SOP defines clear guidance to the Global Business Service regarding all country specific requirements.

1.2 Framework

This SOP is based on principles and requirements outlined in SSC-PTC-SOP-001 “Manage Product Technical Complaint and Suspected Counterfeit Incidents in GBS”.

2 Abbreviations

AE	Adverse Event
CMO	Contract Manufacturing Organization
CQH	Country Quality Head
CQU	Country Quality Unit
GBS	Global Business Service
OTC products	Over-the-counter products
PTC	Product Technical Complaint
PV	Pharmacovigilance
RQU	Responsible Quality Unit

3 Purpose & Set-Up

3.1 Purpose

Country Specific Requirements for Sweden are described in this SOP, regarding e.g. Data Privacy, Sample Handling Process, Reimbursement Process, Contacts, escalation rules.

During the processing of all PTCs by Bayer owned Global Business Service all country specific requirements are considered and followed besides the general complaint handling described in the SSC-PTC-SOP-001 “Manage Product Technical Complaint and Suspected Counterfeit Incidents in GBS”.

3.2 General guidance

The employees of Global Business Services follow the SOP during complaint processing in the complaint database on behalf of the Country Quality Units.

3.3 Roles and responsibilities

GBS team	- Enters PTCs, Suspected Counterfeit Incidents and Usability Issues according to defined timelines in a timely manner, entering them into the global complaint database in English language - Organizes missing information and asks CQU for any support contacting the complainant if not possible/allowed by GBS (e.g. data privacy, non-hosted language) - Performs the initial intake of complaints after receipt - Informs the CQU about all PTCs where local authorities are involved, about all potential counterfeits and any other cases described in this SOP - Informs the respective PV about all PTCs with a potential associated AE or LODE or potentially reportable medical device complaints, including the unique complaint database number and all relevant follow-up information - Forwards the case to the respective RQU for further assessment - Initiates the process of sample shipment if requested by RQU or specified in any other guidance document - Reviews the case for plausibility and closes the complaint case in complaint database - Sends out standard response letters in case it is agreed with the CQU - Forwards all cases that are not PTCs back to the CQU or to the appropriate function for further processing
Country Quality Head (CQH) / Country Quality Unit (CQU)	- Is responsible for regular KPI evaluation to get overview of complaint activities at the GBS - Supports the GBS in organizing missing complaint information - Organizes the complaint sample and sends it to the RQU if requested. - Sends out the Response Letters to the complainants as requested and agreed with the GBS - Contacts local CMO on request of GBS as RQU to get investigation reports from the respective CMO - Ensures that all changes within the country law and regulation are directly notified to the GBS and that the Country Specific SOP is updated

4 Specific requirements regarding PTC handling

4.1 Country Specific Requirements listed by different topics

Description	Assigned Roles & Document Reference
4.1.1 General Information Legal entity in Sweden: Swedish office: Bayer AB Country Quality Nobels väg 8 171 65 Solna , Sweden	
4.1.2 Contact list Complaints for Sweden are received at the general email address: reklamationer@bayer.com The generic email address: quality.nordic@bayer.com can be used for internal communication between CQU and GBS PTC officers. **Remark:** Current name and e-mail address of CQH and CQH deputy are found on the QINT SharePoint: *https://bayergroup.sharepoint.com/sites/oneqint/SitePages/Who%20are%20we.aspx#country-quality-list*	
4.1.3 Escalation Rules The CQH and the CQH deputy should be notified via notification/immediate action in the complaint database about any complaint case referring to at least one of the following situations: - Suspected Counterfeit Cases - Any cases involving Health Authorities (HA list specified in 4.1.14) - Cases with final risk category high or medium (escalation via immediate action) **Remark:** The current names and e-mail addresses of the CQH and the CQH deputy are found on the QINT SharePoint: *https://bayergroup.sharepoint.com/sites/oneqint/SitePages/Who%20are%20we.aspx#country-quality-list*	GBS
4.1.4 Pharmacovigilance cases	GBS

Description	Assigned Roles & Document Reference
If a complaint case is related to any type of Adverse Event, the Pharmacovigilance department has to be informed within 24 hours via the following e-mail address: *pv.nordics@bayer.com*	
4.1.5 Product Samples Complaint samples can be obtained from pharmacies, wholesalers, parallel importers, health care providers or private consumers. The complainants are requested to send the samples for investigation directly to RQU provided the sample is requested by RQU. There is also an option of collecting the sample directly from the complainant at Bayer's cost. The consumer needs to be notified about the reimbursement rules, so it is advised to ask the consumer to leave the sample at the pharmacy. If the sample shipment is proceeded without the pharmacy involvement, then the customer is not entitled to apply for reimbursement from Bayer. **Sample shipment**: To collect the sample from the complainant, the shipment order (Budunderlag) must be filled in with information received from the consumer about the packages weight and measurements, address of the pickup point, telephone number, email address and name of the person responsible for the package. The shipment order also includes the destination address and Purchase Order number. The complainant should be notified to write the PTC number on the package. The shipment order form is available in Annex 6 with already filled in purchase order number for UPS which is 750366637. Completed shipment order form with a preferred pick-up time should be sent to the Swedish reception desk at *receptionist.extra.ext@bayer.com*. **Radiology Samples:** If requested by regional manager or RQU, the medical device sample is shipped to manufacturing site or lead investigation site with CQH coordination.	GBS
4.1.6 Statement letter **Acknowledgement Letter when a complaint comes in:** Received complaints from external sources require acknowledgement letter. Standard acknowledgement letter is filled in by GBS PTC officer according to templates in Annex 2. **Response Letter after closing:** Standard response letters are sent out without involvement of the CQU only when requested by the complainant. Standard response letter is provided in Annex 3. **Exception:** # Confirmed final risk categories high and medium # In case of PTC + AE: involvement of PV # Authority responses	GBS

Description	Assigned Roles & Document Reference
Radiology Response Letter: Response letter is requested from the RQU by the PTC officer at *ricustomercomplaints@bayer.com* when the final risk classification is medium or high Response letter is provided by PTC officer when the final risk classification is low. Template with the response letter in Annex 8 should be filled in accordingly. **Primovist Plunger Resistance Response letter**: See details in section 4.1.14 Others.	
4.1.7 RQU Contact list A table with all available products in the country, needed for entry into the complaint database, is available on SharePoint: go/ptcops. For CH products registration status in the respective country as well as Manufacturing Site are available via SYNAPS: go/synaps. List with the respective RQU contact names are provided by the Divisional Quality Assurance function and available on the SharePoint: PH: *PH RQU responsible list_HJ.xlsx* CH: *IQMS_MASTER LIST COMPLAINT RESPONSIBILITIES.xlsx*	GBS
4.1.8 List of Local Opportunities Products n/a	
4.1.9 Data Privacy Requirements Sweden follows the rules of the same EU GDPR act, hence there is no restrictions in personal data flow. Every e-mail should contain data privacy statement.	
4.1.10 Gathering additional information (including obtaining translation) In case when the CQU receives a complaint first by a phone, then Product Complaint Form (see Annex 1) is used to document received information. The CQU sends this form to the GBS via e-mail. Complaints in Swedish are hosted in GBS office by GBS PTC officer with Swedish language. In case of the absence, the backup officers follow the translation rules in regards with standard procedure for macro languages.	GBS CQU
4.1.11 Reimbursement and Replacement Complainants may only receive replacement products or refunds via the pharmacy or retailer and the decision is up to them. The pharmacy can then be repaid/credited by the wholesaler that provided the product to the pharmacy/retailer. Complaint samples should be returned as followed:	GBS

Description	Assigned Roles & Document Reference

PH products – the sample can be returned in any pharmacy

CH products – the sample can be returned only at the pharmacy it was purchased at.

BT products - return at the pharmacy and usually to the wholesaler is not possible due to the products nature (refrigerated goods), however reimbursement is further taken by the Customer Service.

RD products – reimbursement is upon business decision of Country Group Head Nordics or Regional Business Manager.

For questions regarding reimbursements from the wholesalers, Customer service can be contacted at: customerservice.scandinavia@bayer.com

4.1.12 Mandatory Spot Checks for Translations

GBS

For all countries where the complaints are sent out for translation to the translation tool, once a year mandatory spot checks must be performed. 5% of all complaint numbers per year should by checked by native speaker (based on random selection), e.g. CQU. Important is to check the “original income text” with “translated text” provided by translation provider.

The GBS is the owner of the process and start this action. The GBS leads the process, picks the cases and provides report to the CQU. The CQU checks the translation and indicates the deviations.

Acceptance Criteria:

- No Major translation deviations
- Total number of Minor translation deviations is less than 5%.

. Deviations in the translation can be described as Minor or Major.

- Minor translation deviations are deviations where a single word or short section of a sentence has been insufficiently translated, but the essence or meaning of the original message is still captured.
- Major translation deviations are deviations where a single word or short section has been incorrectly translated (for example by the introduction of a new word or exclusion of a word from the original complaint in the translated version) which results in an incorrect essence or meaning in the translation of the original message.

In case of a major translation deviation and exceeding 5% minor cases, the GBS will be informed promptly to open a deviation in the complaint database and to ensure appropriate CAPAs.

In addition, the translation office needs to be informed.

4.1.13 Exceptions and special cases

Complaints received via phone call:

Complaints may also come via phone to the CQU office or to external call receiving company. Such complaints should be entered in English by the phone call receiver preferably to the PTC complaint form (Annex 1) and forwarded to GBS.

Description	Assigned Roles & Document Reference

4.1.14 Others

Names of the Swedish health authorities:

1) Medicinal Products Agency (MPA) / Läkemedelsverket (LV)

Forwarding list:

1. Complaints of **diabetes products** should be forwarded to:
   SE: *diabetes@ascensia.com*

2. Complaints of **Animal Health products** should be forwarded to:
   QA-nordic@elanco.com

3. Complaints of **Crop Science products** should be forwarded to:
   Poul Bjerre Jensen (poul.jensen@bayer.com)

4. **Nasonex complaints** should be forwarded to Organon:
   SE: *dpoc.sweden@organon.com*

5. **Androcur** complaints should be forwarded to:
   medicalinformation@advanzpharma.com

6. **Nimotop** complaints should be forwarded to:
   assurancequalite@laboratoirexo.com

Primovist Plunger Resistance Response letter:
Confirmed Quality defect cases regarding Plunger mobility issues of Primovist 10 mL pre-filled glass syringes should be answered with the template from Annex 8.

Details about incoming case which is later forwarded to Organon should be shared with the respective CQH (Teams channel named Reconciliation Nasonex-Organon)).

For cases out of scope for complaints database entry but forwarded to PV or MedInfo, PTC officer replies with Acknowledgement mail (Annex 5).

5 Internal References

- SSC-PTC-SOP-001 “Manage Product Technical Complaints and Suspected Counterfeit Incidents in GBS”

6 External References

- N/A

History of changes

Version	Significant changes with respect to previous version	Effective Date *(yyyy-mm-dd)*
1.0	New document	2024-11-30
2.0	# Training role updated # Roles and responsibilities updated based on SSC-PTC-SOP-001 v.6.0 # replaced “Dev@Com” with complaints database # risk class nomenclature changed to medium and high 4.1.2 names of the CQH’s removed 4.1.7 updated RQU contact list 4.1.9 Data Privacy Requirements (removed part related to Dev@Com) 4.1.10 information about timelines removed 4.1.11 added division by product type 4.1.13 external call receiving company added 4.1.14 -updated Crop Science products contact Poul Jensen -added new Primovist Plunger Resistance response letter (see Annex 8) -removed information about MedInfo # New Annex 7 added Primovist Plunger Resistance response letter	2025-06-13
3.0	4.1.14 added health authorities list # Added Androcur and Nimotop forwarding list #annex 8 response letter for RD low risk added Acknowledgement #updated acknowledgement added 4.1.6 Radiology response letter paragraph added	See coversheet

Annexes

Annex 1

Product Complaint Form

Complaint created (date)……
Complaint received (date) ……

Product information:	
Product name	
Batch / lot number	
Dosage form *(cream, tablet, capsule, etc.)*	
Package type/size	
Number of packages	
Sample available?*	Yes/No
*Sample available = please keep for further potential shipment	

Complaint information:	
Complaint description (defect description, is it suspected counterfeit case, etc.)	
Adverse event reported?	Yes/No
Does the complainant expect a response from Bayer?**	
**By requesting a response, the Complainant agrees to his/hers contact data being processed by Bayer for the purpose of providing the answer to the submitted complaint *(the exact sounding to be aligned with legal)*	

Complainants' contact information attention: in the countries with special Data Privacy regulations to be replaced by the complainant code number (to be given by CQU)	
Name and surname	
E-mail address	
Telephone	
Home address	

Sender (if other than Complainant, e.g. a pharmacy)	
Senders' Name (Legal entity)	
Address	
E-Mail address	
Telephone number	

Any additional information	

Annex 2



Standard acknowledgement.do

Annex 3



Standard response letter

Annex 4



MedInfo/PV reply

Annex 5



Budunderlag/ Shipment order

Annex 6



IUS replacement

Annex 7



Primovist Plunger Resistance Customer

Annex 8



Radiology Response Letter low risk.docx

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